

system which can run on your current PCs and even Macs.

There are many advantages of using Ubuntu or any other GNU/Linux operating system. The number one is freedom. Here you will not be bound by hefty end-user licence agreement which will make you a 'pirate'—a 'thief' if you give a copy of the software to your brother or a friend. Once you download or get a copy of Ubuntu, you are free to replicate it and give it to as many people as you want.

Ubuntu, like most of the GNU/Linux operating systems, comes for free. You will not have to pay a single paisa to get the copy. What's more, if you don't have a good download speed and you want to try Ubuntu, you can order it from their website and they will send it to you for free.

With Ubuntu 9.04 version, you will get Open Office Suite (a powerful alternative to MS Word) and GIMP (a free alternative to Photoshop). Then you will get Pidgin, which will enable you to chat with Google, MSN, Yahoo! users at the same time. Coming to additional software, you can listen to music through Amarok, which is far more advanced than Windows Media Player. Then there is VLC, which enables you to play any movie format. You have GTKpod and GpoxPod to sync movies and images to your iPod.

India launches spy satellite

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has put into orbit the country's first all-weather spy satellite—RISAT-2. The mission was carried out from Satish Dhawan Space Centre SHAR, Sriharikota. The intended orbit of the satellite is at 550 km with an



PSLV-C12 carrying RISAT-2 and ANUSAT satellites

inclination of 41 degrees.

RISAT-2 is capable of taking images of the earth during day and night as well as cloudy conditions. It weighs 300 kg and will have a life-span of three years. This satellite will be used to monitor India's borders and as part of anti-infiltration and anti-terrorist operations. The spacecraft is built by Israeli Aerospace Industries. It will enhance ISRO's capability for earth observation, especially during floods, cyclones, landslides and management of disasters in a more effective way.

In addition to RISAT-2, the polar satellite launch vehicle also carried a 40kg micro satellite, named ANUSAT, built by Anna University, Chennai.

ANUSAT is the first experimental communication satellite built by an Indian university under the overall guidance of ISRO and will demonstrate the technologies related to message store-and-forward operations. It carries an amateur radio and technology demonstration experiments.

Access Facebook on the fly

Tata Indicom subscribers can now enjoy Facebook through SMS. The service enables users to receive via SMS their messages and notifications from Facebook and they can reply back, send messages and set their Facebook status via SMS. When the user is offline or busy at work, he

can stay connected and share with his friends on Facebook.

To activate the service, Tata Indicom subscribers can register their mobile number on Facebook and start receiving via SMS Facebook messages and notifications. Users can update their Facebook status at any time by sending a text message to the short code 51555. They will be charged Re 1 for every SMS sent via short code.

Users can also search/add friends, poke them, write on their wall, post messages and comment on their friend's activity right from their phone simply with SMS. They can also upload their mobile photos by sending MMS to mobile@facebook.com.



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